Southern New Hampshire University

IT 253 Project One Consultant Findings

We were hired to provide an evaluation of the company's current information security program and identify high risks that should be addressed by the company. We understand and recognize that information security function at the company is still in its infancy, but our findings should help you to prioritize your initial efforts. We were impressed with your leadership's commitment to support and to dedicating resources to ensure that these issues are addressed in a timely manner.

Our consultant assessed the existence or absence of technical, physical, and administrative controls. Our evaluation was not limited only to particular systems, but also evaluated existing people, processes, and technologies, and how each element impacts the company's information security posture.

The following high-risk findings were identified by our consultant:

- Our team was able to access your headquarters building without a valid badge. We simply waited near a side entrance and followed another employee inside.
- Your data center did require badge access, but any employee or visitor with a badge could access the space.
- Backups were being kept on-site and were not encrypted.
- When speaking to employees, we found that they were unaware of what to do when they receive phishing or other suspicious emails.
- The current information security policy had not been updated in four years.
- Our assessors noticed that many workstations were actively logged on and accessible, but no employees were using them.
- No business continuity plan or disaster recovery plan exists.
- When we interviewed your IT staff, they told us that they use a shared account for performing high-level system administrator functions. They were also unsure of what, if any, security responsibilities they had.
- Your company wireless network is configured to use WEP.
- System and security logs are not being stored in a central location.
- Mobile devices, such as laptops and phones, are not encrypted.
- Your data center did not have backup or generator power.
- In a review of user workstations, over 35% had anti-virus definitions over 30 days old.

While we focused on only a subset of high-risk areas initially, addressing multiple risks will dramatically reduce the company's exposure to threats. You should have a follow-up evaluation after these issues are addressed to identify additional areas of opportunity.